

Feedico Sync — How to Use (Complete Guide)

This guide explains **Feedico Sync** end to end: installation, admin configuration, scheduled and manual sync, merchants and coupons, front-end shortcodes and blocks, WordPress post types, privacy, uninstall, and troubleshooting. It targets plugin release family **1.7.x**. Some labels in the WordPress admin may still follow your site language pack.

Table of contents

1. What is this plugin?
 2. Requirements
 3. Installation
 4. Admin menu layout
 5. Main settings screen (Feedico Sync)
 6. Connection
 7. Networks to sync
 8. Dashboard (API) cards
 9. Sync schedule
 10. Removing the plugin (notice)
 11. Showing merchants and coupons on the site
 12. Manual sync and last run summary
 13. Recent sync logs
 14. Merchants list
 15. Merchant edit screen
 16. Create landing page
 17. Coupons list
 18. Coupon edit screen
 19. Front end: shortcode reference
 20. Front end: Gutenberg blocks
 21. Front end: search and pagination URL parameters
 22. Appearance: CSS and JavaScript
 23. WordPress post types (CPT) and SEO
 24. Data model (database summary)
 25. How credentials are stored (encryption)
 26. Privacy: export and erase
 27. Complete uninstall and data removal
 28. Troubleshooting
 29. Appendix A — Producing a PDF from this Markdown
 30. Appendix B — Quick reference
 31. Appendix C — Admin AJAX and admin-post actions (developers)
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1. What is this plugin?

Feedico Sync connects your WordPress site to the Feedico API:

- Stores merchant and coupon data in **custom database tables**.
- Optionally mirrors rows as **WordPress post types** (`feedico_store`, `feedico_coupon`).
- Renders visitor-facing grids and lists via **shortcodes** and **Gutenberg blocks**.
- Runs **scheduled or manual** full sync jobs.

Example API base (see `Feedico_API` in code): <https://api.feedico.io/api/v1/...>

2. Requirements

Component	Minimum
WordPress	6.0+ (see plugin header / <code>readme.txt</code>)
PHP	7.4+
PHP extension	OpenSSL recommended for strong encryption (a fallback path exists if OpenSSL is missing)
Capability	Typically manage_options to manage plugin settings

3. Installation

1. Copy the plugin folder to `wp-content/plugins/feedico-sync/` or upload the ZIP under **Plugins** → **Add New**.
2. **Activate Feedico Sync** on the **Plugins** screen.
3. On activation the plugin typically:
 - Creates or upgrades **custom tables**.
 - Registers **post types**.
 - Participates in **rewrite flush** (`flush_rewrite_rules`) on activation.

Open **Feedico Sync** from the admin menu for first-time setup.

4. Admin menu layout

Under **Feedico Sync** in the left menu you will usually see:

Menu item	Purpose
Feedico Sync	Main settings: connection, networks, schedule, logs
Merchants	Full merchant data grid
Coupons	Full coupon data grid

Screens reached **only by URL** (no submenu label):

- `admin.php?page=feedico-sync-merchant-edit&merchant_id=...` — single merchant editor
- `admin.php?page=feedico-sync-coupon-edit&coupon_id=...` — single coupon editor

5. Main settings screen (Feedico Sync)

On `wp-admin/admin.php?page=feedico-sync` you will find:

1. **Hero header** — shortcuts to Merchants and Coupons
2. **Last sync summary** — colored banner (success or error)
3. **Run sync now** — starts a full sync via AJAX

4. **Connection + network picker + API dashboard** — two-column layout
5. **Sync schedule** — WP-Cron interval plus **last sync duration** side panel
6. **Removing the plugin** — explains default uninstall behavior
7. **Show merchants & coupons on the site** — shortcode / block cheat sheet
8. **Save settings** — submits the settings form
9. **Recent sync logs** — full-width table below the form

If saved credentials exist, **Dashboard (API)** cards may **refresh in the background** after page load so numbers stay current without clicking **Test connection**.

6. Connection

Fields:

Field	Description
Email	Feedico account email
Password	Optional; leave blank to keep the password already stored on the server
API token	Optional; leave blank to keep the stored token

Test connection:

- Calls AJAX action `feedico_sync_test`.
- On success: updates connection flag, last dashboard payload, network catalog; then reloads the page.

Save settings: email is always updated; password and token are re-saved **only** when the fields are non-empty (encrypted before storage).

7. Networks to sync

- After a successful connection test, **affiliate networks** appear as checkboxes.
- Checked networks drive **provider filters** during sync.
- The list comes from the dashboard-derived catalog; a background refresh tries to **preserve** checkbox state in the browser when possible.

Save settings writes the selection to option `feedico_sync_selected_networks`.

8. Dashboard (API) cards

- Shows summary information for networks linked to your Feedico account.
 - Data is cached in option `feedico_sync_last_dashboard`; **Test connection** and (when enabled) **page-load refresh** update it.
 - These cards are **not** the same as **local sync statistics** (those come from the sync job and log tables).
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9. Sync schedule

Interval

Pick one recurrence registered with WordPress `cron_schedules`:

- Minutes: **5, 10, 15, 30, 45**
- Hours: **hourly, 2 / 4 / 6 / 12** hours
- Core schedules: **twicedaily, daily**
- **Once weekly**
- **Custom interval (minutes)** between **5** and **10080** (7 days)

When **Custom** is selected, the **Minutes between runs** field appears.

Last sync duration

- Shows how long the last full sync **run** took on the server (for example **3 min 12 sec**).
- The note recommends choosing an interval **comfortably longer** than this duration so overlapping WP-Cron triggers are less likely. Actual timing still depends on **traffic** and **hosting**.

Next WP-Cron

The screen shows the next scheduled run time. WP-Cron is **not** a system crontab; for wall-clock accuracy use a real server cron hitting `wp-cron.php` (see WordPress documentation).

10. Removing the plugin (notice)

Default behavior: uninstalling the plugin **does not** drop custom tables or mirrored posts, so you can reinstall without losing data.

For a **full wipe**, add the following to `wp-config.php` **before** uninstalling:

```
define( 'FEEDICO_SYNC_DELETE_DATA', true );
```

See Complete uninstall and data removal.

11. Showing merchants and coupons on the site

The settings card summarizes:

- Blocks: `feedico/merchants`, `feedico/coupons`, `feedico/merchant-page`
- Shortcodes: `[feedico_merchants]`, `[feedico_coupons]`, `[feedico_merchant_page]`

Visitors only see records considered **active** after sync (`wp_feedico_active` and passive-marking rules).

Front-end stylesheet: `wp-content/plugins/feedico-sync/assets/public.css`

12. Manual sync and last run summary

- **Run sync now** runs `Feedico_Sync_Job::run( 'manual' )`.
- **Prerequisite:** stored **email** and **API token** must be present; if the token is missing the job stops with an error such as “Email and API token are required.”
- Status text updates in place; response may include fresh **banner** HTML.
- Last run metadata is stored in option `feedico_sync_last_run` (finish time, trigger, success flag, stats, **duration**, etc.).

Scheduled runs use hook `feedico_sync_cron` and call `run( 'cron' )`.

13. Recent sync logs

Table columns (database `{prefix}feedico_sync_log`):

Column	Meaning
ID	Log row id
Started / Finished	Timestamps
Status	For example success or error
Trigger	cron or manual
Stats / error	JSON stats summary or error text

14. Merchants list

Feedico Sync → Merchants

- 30 rows per page, sortable columns, search box.
- Columns (labels may be translated): Name, Description, ID, Provider, Coupons (active), Website, Status, Active, Last sync.

Row actions (capability-dependent):

- **Edit** — full-page merchant editor
- **Create landing page** — creates a draft **Page** containing the merchant shortcode (see below)

15. Merchant edit screen

URL: `admin.php?page=feedico-sync-merchant-edit&merchant_id={PRIMARY_KEY}`

Read-only reference:

- Record ID, Provider, Property ID, External merchant key, Last synced (API)

Editable fields:

Field	Description
Display name	Public label
Description	Long text
Website URL	<code>example.com</code> or full <code>https://...</code>
Status	Status string from the API

Field	Description
Active in WordPress	Uncheck to hide the merchant and related presentation without deleting the row

Manual edit lock

- Saving the form typically **sets** the lock so future syncs **preserve** your WordPress edits (implementation in `Feedico_DB / sync job`).
- Checkbox **On save, clear the lock...** removes the lock so the **next sync** can overwrite these fields from the API again.

16. Create landing page

From the merchants list, **Create landing page**:

- Uses `admin-post.php` action `feedico_create_merchant_landing` (nonce protected).
- Inserts a **draft Page** with:
 - Title pattern `{Merchant name} - Coupons` (translatable string)
 - Intro paragraph plus block markup for `[feedico_merchant_page merchant_id="..."]`
- Redirects you to the WordPress **page editor**.

Capabilities: `manage_options` and `edit_pages`.

17. Coupons list

Feedico Sync → Coupons

- **30** rows per page, sortable columns (default ordering is often `wp_row_updated_at` descending), search box.

Columns:

Column	Summary
Title	Title plus coupon ID on a second line
Network	Network name or shortened <code>network_id</code>
Merchant ID	Linked merchant primary key
Code	Coupon code
Discount	Discount type + value + optional currency
Ends	End time
Active	Yes / No (<code>wp_feedico_active</code>)
Offer link	External Open link

Row action: **Edit** opens the full coupon editor.

18. Coupon edit screen

URL: `admin.php?page=feedico-sync-coupon-edit&coupon_id={PRIMARY_KEY}`

Reference:

- Coupon ID, Merchant ID, Network ID, Created / updated (API)

Editable fields:

Field	Description
Title	Offer title
Description	Long text
Coupon code	Code string
Affiliate / offer URL	Click-through URL
Image URL	Creative image URL
Network name	Display network label
Starts at / Ends at	Usually API-style ISO 8601 strings
Discount type / Discount value	Discount metadata
Currency code	Currency
Status	Status string
Active in WordPress	Whether the coupon appears on the front end

Manual edit lock: same model as merchants; use the checkbox to allow the next sync to overwrite from the API.

19. Front end: shortcode reference

Shortcodes are registered in `Feedico_Public`. Public CSS and JS load the first time a shortcode renders.

`[feedico_merchants]`

Attribute	Default	Range / notes
<code>per_page</code>	24	1–100
<code>page</code>	1	Query var <code>fcm_p</code> usually wins

Features:

- Search query: GET `fcm_q`
- Pagination: GET `fcm_p`
- **Coupons** link on each merchant card adds `fcc_mid` to the current page URL

`[feedico_coupons]`

Attribute	Default	Notes
<code>per_page</code>	24	1–100
<code>page</code>	1	Overridable by <code>fcc_p</code>
<code>merchant_id</code>	empty	Restrict to one merchant
<code>wrapper</code>	1	0, no, false, off drop the outer wrapper

Attribute	Default	Notes
search_form	0	Set 1 to show search

GET parameters: fcc_q, fcc_p, fcc_mid (URL fcc_mid applies when the shortcode omits merchant_id).

[feedico_merchant_page]

Attribute	Default	Notes
merchant_id	—	Required merchant primary key / ref
per_page	24	1–100
search_form	0	
show_hero	1	0 hides the hero header block

Internally renders [feedico_coupons] with wrapper=0 and the same merchant_id.

20. Front end: Gutenberg blocks

Block name	Maps to shortcode behavior
feedico/merchants	perPage (1–100)
feedico/coupons	merchantId, perPage, showSearch, wrapOuter
feedico/merchant-page	merchantId, perPage, showSearch, showHero

If **merchant-page** has an empty ID, the block may show an editor-only reminder to set the ID in the sidebar.

21. Front end: search and pagination URL parameters

Parameter	Shortcode context	Meaning
fcm_q	merchants	Search text
fcm_p	merchants	Page number
fcc_q	coupons	Search text
fcc_p	coupons	Page number
fcc_mid	coupons	Merchant filter

22. Appearance: CSS and JavaScript

- **assets/public.css** — front-end layout under .feedico-pub
- **assets/public.js** — for example copy-button strings via feedicoPub localization

Override in a child theme or **Appearance** → **Customize** → **Additional CSS** if a theme clashes.

23. WordPress post types (CPT) and SEO

The sync pipeline can create or update **WordPress posts** bound to custom table rows.

Admin menus and URLs

Separate admin menu entries:

- **Feedico Stores** (`feedico_store`) — rewrite base `/feedico-store/` (single and archive URLs follow WordPress rewrite rules)
- **Feedico Coupons** (`feedico_coupon`) — `/feedico-coupon/`

Both support **title** and **content** editors and expose **REST** (`show_in_rest`).

Store post (`feedico_store`)

- Hidden meta `_feedico_entity_id` links to the merchants table primary key.
- On save, title and plain-text content may flow back through `Feedico_DB::update_merchant_from_cpt` (guarded against sync loops).

Coupon post (`feedico_coupon`)

- Also uses `_feedico_entity_id`.
- **Coupon details** meta box fields:
 - **Coupon code** → `feedico_coupon_code`
 - **Affiliate URL** → `feedico_affiliate_url`
 - **Expiry (end date / ISO)** → `feedico_expires_at`
- Creating a brand-new coupon **only** from this screen does **not** insert a Feedico table row; the authoritative source is **Feedico Sync admin + API sync**. Editing an existing mirrored coupon can update the table row.

SEO

`Feedico_Seo` adds `noindex` to singles and archives for these post types by default. Allow indexing with:

```
add_filter( 'feedico_sync_cpt_noindex', '__return_false' );
```

You are responsible for SEO and legal compliance when enabling indexing.

24. Data model (database summary)

With WordPress table prefix `{prefix}`:

Table	Purpose
<code>{prefix}feedico_merchants</code>	Merchant rows + JSON payload
<code>{prefix}feedico_coupons</code>	Coupon rows + JSON payload
<code>{prefix}feedico_sync_log</code>	Sync run logs

Important flags: `wp_feedico_active`, `wp_manual_override`, `wp_deactivated_at`.

25. How credentials are stored (encryption)

Feedico_Crypto:

- With OpenSSL: **AES-256-CBC** using a key derived from WordPress **salts**.
- Without OpenSSL: weak legacy fallback — enable OpenSSL in production.

Option keys include: `feedico_sync_email`, `feedico_sync_password_enc`, `feedico_sync_token_enc`.

26. Privacy: export and erase

Under **Tools** → **Export Personal Data** and **Erase Personal Data**:

- **Export**: if the request email matches the stored Feedico email, the export bundle includes that fact.
 - **Erase**: if it matches, plugin options are deleted and `feedico_sync_cron` is unscheduled; **custom tables are not dropped** (see `readme.txt`).
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27. Complete uninstall and data removal

1. **Default**: deleting the plugin leaves tables and CPT posts.
2. **Full removal**: before deleting the plugin, set in `wp-config.php`:

```
define( 'FEEDICO_SYNC_DELETE_DATA', true );
```

Then `uninstall.php`:

- Drops custom tables
 - Deletes `feedico_store` and `feedico_coupon` posts
 - Deletes known options
 - Clears the scheduled cron hook
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28. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause / fix
Dashboard empty or stale	Run Test connection ; verify email + token
Sync says no networks	Check network checkboxes, Save settings
WP-Cron never fires	Low-traffic sites: use a real server cron
Edits overwritten after sync	Check manual lock ; use “clear lock” only when you want API data
No coupons on front end	<code>wp_feedico_active</code> , passive rules, last successful sync
Encryption issues	Enable PHP openssl extension

29. Appendix A — Producing a PDF from this Markdown

This guide ships as **Markdown** (`.md`). Common PDF workflows:

1) Pandoc (recommended on desktop)

<https://pandoc.org>

Example (adjust the path to your site):

```
cd /path/to/wp-content/plugins/feedico-sync/docs
pandoc HOW-T0.md -o Feedico-Sync-How-To.pdf --pdf-engine=xelatex -V lang=en
```

Without xelatex:

```
pandoc HOW-T0.md -o Feedico-Sync-How-To.pdf --pdf-engine=wkhtmltopdf
```

2) Browser print to PDF

1. Open a rendered preview (VS Code Markdown preview, GitHub, etc.).
2. **Ctrl+P / Cmd+P → Save as PDF / Microsoft Print to PDF.**

3) VS Code extensions

Extensions such as “Markdown PDF” can export .md directly to .pdf.

Note: For complex tables, Pandoc with LaTeX or wkhtmltopdf usually yields the cleanest layout.

30. Appendix B — Quick reference

What	Where
Main settings	wp-admin/admin.php?page=feedico-sync
Merchants grid	...page=feedico-sync-merchants
Coupons grid	...page=feedico-sync-coupons
Merchant editor	...page=feedico-sync-merchant-edit&merchant_id=...
Coupon editor	...page=feedico-sync-coupon-edit&coupon_id=...

Example shortcodes:

```
[feedico_merchants per_page="24"]
[feedico_coupons per_page="24" merchant_id="PRIMARY_KEY"]
[feedico_merchant_page merchant_id="PRIMARY_KEY" per_page="24" show_hero="1" search_form="0"]
```

31. Appendix C — Admin AJAX and admin-post actions (developers)

AJAX (admin-ajax.php)

All require `manage_options` plus nonce `feedico_sync_ajax`.

action	Role
<code>feedico_sync_test</code>	POST email, password, token — connection test + dashboard + catalog
<code>feedico_sync_run</code>	Manual full sync; response includes <code>banner_html</code> , <code>last_sync_duration</code> , etc.

action	Role
feedico_sync_refresh_dashboard	Refresh dashboard from stored credentials (main settings screen)

admin-post.php

action	Role
feedico_save_merchant	Merchant editor form save
feedico_save_coupon	Coupon editor form save
feedico_create_merchant_landing	GET + nonce — draft landing page

This document is aligned with the `feedico-sync` source tree (`includes/`, `assets/`, `feedico-sync.php`, `uninstall.php`, `readme.txt`). When the product changes, treat the code as the source of truth.